STATEMENT OF INTEREST

Application for the Research Assistant Position in Assam

Dear Selection Committee,

I am Angsuman Das, a PhD Scholar in the Department of Zoology at Mizoram University and a CSIR-NET JRF awardee with AIR 180. My current research is in bioinformatics, through which I have developed skills in Python programming and biological data analysis. I am currently working from home and have received permission from my research guide to apply for this position. I am available for the November 2026-April 2027 period.

My interest in this project comes from a connection with wildlife that began well before my PhD. My home is very close to Nameri National Park in Assam. As children, we used to visit Nameri on our bicycles. Growing up near that landscape made the forests and biodiversity of Assam a familiar part of my life. That connection has stayed with me, even as my research has moved towards computational biology.

My academic foundation is in Zoology. My earlier research included studying the physicochemical characteristics of the Bohimora River alongside its macroinvertebrate diversity. I also gained research exposure at Tocklai through a project involving the tea looper pest, Hyposidra talaca, and pheromone-based management. These experiences gave me opportunities to think about biological questions in relation to organisms and their environment.

During my PhD, I have developed another side of my research interests: working with biological data and using programming to understand it. I would like to bring those skills into wildlife research. I see opportunities to contribute to the organization, processing and analysis of data collected through ecological surveys and monitoring, while learning how those data connect to observations made in the field.

This is what draws me to the Research Assistant position. It brings together my background in Zoology, my earlier ecological research exposure, my computational skills and my personal connection with Assam. I would value the opportunity to learn the field methods used by your team, including camera trapping and acoustic monitoring, and to contribute wherever my existing skills are useful. I would approach the work with patience, curiosity and respect for the researchers, forest personnel and local communities who know these landscapes closely.

Alongside my research, I run ANGSUMI, my agency, at www.angsumi.online. My resume and portfolio are available at angsumi.online/cv for further details about my background and work.

For me, this position is an opportunity to bring different parts of my research journey together. I grew up close to the forests of Assam, trained in Zoology and later developed computational skills during my PhD. I would now like to use that experience to contribute to field-based wildlife research in Assam and learn from the team carrying it out.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,
Angsuman Das
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